

La Verbená — Business Profile

Prepared by María Elena Vargas, Owner Last updated: 2025-04-10

Concept

La Verbená is a counter-service taquería on Mission Street serving traditional Mexico City-style tacos, burritos, tortas, and house-made aguas frescas. We focus on a tight menu, fresh masa, and quick service for the lunch and dinner rush. We do **not** serve alcohol. We do **not** operate a delivery fleet — third-party delivery is available only through DoorDash and Uber Eats, who pick up orders at the counter.

History

I (María Elena Vargas) registered Taquería La Verbená LLC with the California Secretary of State on **March 30, 2022** (file # 202351410842) and obtained the SF business registration on **April 12, 2022**. The business effectively began operating on **April 18, 2022**.

The first location (2022–2024) was a small shared commissary kitchen at 2845 24th Street, where we built up the brand through farmers' markets, catering, and a window-pickup operation. We moved into our current storefront at **3128 Mission Street** on **May 1, 2024**, when the lease on the previous space expired and the Mission Street space (a former sandwich shop) became available.

Premises — 3128 Mission Street

- Ground-floor storefront in a mixed-use building (apartments above).
- Approximately **900 sq ft** total leased area.
 - Front-of-house / dining: ~450 sq ft, **18 seats** (counter service).
 - Kitchen / prep / dish: ~380 sq ft.
 - Storage / dry goods / staff: ~70 sq ft.
- Hours: **11:00 to 22:00 daily**. Closed Thanksgiving and Christmas Day.
- No on-site parking; no drive-thru; no outdoor seating.

Construction details

- Building constructed **1924**; mixed-use (residential above commercial).
- **Type V wood-frame** construction with stucco exterior on the street-facing facade and lath-and-plaster interior walls.
- **Composition shingle roof** (last re-roofed by landlord in 2019 per the lease disclosure).
- **Electrical**: main panel and tenant feed updated in 2018 (200A service). All kitchen circuits on dedicated breakers; Type-1 hood with ANSUL R-102 wet-chemical fire-suppression system (semi-annual inspection by Bay Area Fire Protection).

- **Plumbing:** building plumbing is largely original; landlord did a partial repipe of the ground-floor commercial run (galvanized → copper) in 2015 prior to the previous tenant moving in.
- **HVAC:** rooftop package unit serving the storefront only (~5 ton).
- **Sprinklers:** building is sprinklered (NFPA 13).
- **Fire/burglar alarm:** monitored alarm via Bay Cities Security (account # BCS-44210).

Operations description (for ACORD)

Limited-service Mexican restaurant. The business operates a single counter-service location selling prepared tacos, burritos, tortas, and non-alcoholic beverages (aguas frescas, horchata, jamaica, bottled soda) for on-premises dining and customer takeout. No table service. No alcohol sold or served. No delivery employees — third-party delivery platforms (DoorDash, Uber Eats) handle pickup at the counter. Occasional small catering orders (drop-off only, within San Francisco) account for about 3% of revenue.

Menu (summary)

- **Tacos** (carnitas, al pastor, suadero, pollo, rajas con queso, hongos, frijoles).
- **Burritos** (same proteins; rice + beans + salsa + crema).
- **Tortas** (same proteins on a telera roll).
- **Sides:** chips, guacamole, rice, beans, elote.
- **Drinks:** aguas frescas (horchata, jamaica, tamarindo), Mexican Coke, Jarritos, sparkling water.
No beer, no wine, no spirits.

Staffing

Role	Count	Status
General Manager	1	FT
Cook	2	FT
Prep cook	1	FT
Counter	2	FT
Counter	2	PT
Total	8	

Owner (María Elena Vargas) is on-site approximately 30 hours per week and is **not** included in the payroll above (she is the sole LLC member and takes member draws, not wages).

Suppliers

- **Produce / dry goods:** Mission Foods Wholesale (weekly).

- **Proteins:** Río Grande Meat Co. (twice weekly).
- **Tortillas:** La Palma Mexicatessen (daily, fresh).
- **Beverages / paper:** US Foods (weekly).
- **Cleaning:** Ecolab (monthly).

Annual revenue

- TTM gross revenue: ~**\$682,000** (12 months ending 2025-03-31).
- Q1 2025 revenue: \$170,400 (see `financials/pnl-2025-ytd.csv`).
- Revenue mix: ~85% food, ~12% non-alcoholic beverage, ~3% catering.

Risk-relevant notes

- One prior loss on 2023-11-08 (grease-fire smoke damage at the commissary, \$7,420 paid). After that incident we installed an upgraded Type-1 hood with ANSUL suppression at the new location and enrolled in a quarterly hood-cleaning program with Bay Area Fire Protection (vendor # BAFP-22-310).
- We do not own any vehicles. Owner uses personal vehicle for occasional supply runs only.
- We do not host live music, special events, or after-hours rentals.